

Amitabh Bachchan born 11 October 1942 an Indian actor who works in Hindi cinema. He is considered one of the greatest, most accomplished and commercially successful actors in the history of Indian cinema. With a cinematic career spanning over five decades, he has played in over 200 films. Bachchan has been called as the Shahenshah of Bollywood, Sadi ke Mahanayak (translated as superstar of the century in Hindi), Bollywood's Star of the Millennium, or simply Big B.[9] His dominance in the Indian film industry during the 1970s–80s led the French director François Truffaut to describe it as a "one-man industry". He is a recipient of several accolades including six National Film Awards and sixteen Filmfare Awards.

Bachchan was born in Allahabad (now Prayagraj), and he was educated at Sherwood College, Nainital, Uttarakhand and Kirori Mal College, University of Delhi. His film career started in 1969 as a voice narrator in Mrinal Sen's film *Bhuvan Shome*, followed by work in early films such as *Anand* and *Roti Kapada Aur Makana*. He achieved greater stardom in later years; beginning with *Zanjeer*, *Deewaar*, and *Sholay* that he embodied the "angry young man" in their Hindi films of the 1970s–1980. He consistently starred in the highest grossings of the year, includes *Kabhi Kabhie*, *Hera Pheri*, *Amar Akbar Anthony*, *Don*, *Trishul*, *Muqaddar Ka Sikandar*, *Kaala Patthar*, *Dostana*, *Laawaris* (1981 film), *Coolie* and *Mard*. Bachchan was voted the "greatest star of stage or screen" in the BBC Your Millennium online users poll in 1999. In October 2003, *Time* magazine said he is the undisputed godfather of Bollywood.

After taking a break from acting in the 1990s, his resurgence was marked in 2000 with *Mohabbatein*. Since then he starred in several successful and acclaimed films like *Baghban*, *Kabhi Khushi Kabhie Gham*, *Black*, *Kabhi Alvida Naa Kehna*, *Sarkar*, *Brahmāstra: Part One – Shiva*, and *Kalki 2898 AD*. For *Agneepath*, *Black*, *Paa* and *Piku*; he has won four National Film Award for Best Actor, making him the only actor to do so. Bachchan also made an appearance in a Hollywood film, *The Great Gatsby* (2013), in which he played a non-Indian Jewish character.[19]

Bachchan has won numerous accolades in his career, including record four National Film Awards in Best Actor category and many awards at international film festivals and award ceremonies. He has won sixteen Filmfare Awards and is the most nominated performer in any major acting category at Filmfare with 34 nominations in Best Actor and 42 nominations overall. The Government of India honoured him with the Padma Shri in 1984, the Padma Bhushan in 2001, the Padma Vibhushan in 2015, and India's highest award in the field of cinema, the Dadasaheb Phalke Award in 2018 for his contributions to the arts. The Government of France honoured him with its highest civilian honour, Officer of the Legion of Honour, in 2007 for his exceptional career in the world of cinema and beyond.

In addition to acting, Bachchan has worked as a playback singer, film producer, and television presenter. He has hosted several seasons of the game show *Kaun Banega Crorepati*, India's version of the game show franchise, *Who Wants to Be a Millionaire?*. He also entered politics for a time in the 1980s. Bachchan has also been involved in several humanitarian works and he is a brand endorser in India. Beyond the Indian subcontinent, he acquired a large overseas following of the South Asian diaspora, as well as others, in markets including Africa (South Africa, Eastern Africa, and Mauritius),

the Middle East (especially Egypt and the UAE), the United Kingdom, Russia, Central Asia, the Caribbean (Guyana, Suriname, and Trinidad and Tobago), Oceania (Fiji, Australia, and New Zealand), Canada and the United States.[20]

Early Life and Family of Amitabh Bachchan

Amitabh Bachchan was born on **11 October 1942** in **Allahabad (now Prayagraj)** to renowned Hindi poet **Harivansh Rai Bachchan** and social activist **Teji Bachchan**. His father was an Awadhi Hindu Kayastha with strong command over several languages, while his mother belonged to a Punjabi Sikh Khatri family from Lyallpur (now Faisalabad, Pakistan). He has a younger brother, **Ajitabh Bachchan**.

Originally, Amitabh was to be named **Inquilaab**, but the name **Amitabh** was suggested by poet **Sumitranandan Pant**. Though the family surname was **Srivastava**, his father adopted “**Bachchan**” as a pen name to reject caste identity, and the family later officially adopted it as their surname.

Amitabh completed his schooling at **Boys’ High School & College, Allahabad**, and **Sherwood College, Nainital**, and earned a **B.Sc. degree from Kirori Mal College, University of Delhi**, in 1962. Despite his academic background, early attempts to enter the entertainment industry were challenging—he was rejected by **All India Radio** as a newsreader.

Before joining films, he worked briefly as a **business executive in Kolkata** and was involved in **theatre**. His family shared close ties with the **Nehru–Gandhi family**, and he was personally acquainted with **Rajiv and Sanjay Gandhi**. Encouraged by his mother’s belief in his potential, Amitabh eventually chose a career in acting, setting the stage for his legendary journey in Indian cinema.

Summary – Return to Success (2000–Present)

In **2000**, Amitabh Bachchan faced severe financial संकट after the failure of his production company. At a low point in his career, he approached **Yash Chopra**, who cast him in **Mohabbatein (2000)**. The film marked a major comeback, earned him a **Filmfare Award**, and re-established him as a powerful supporting and character actor.

Following this revival, Bachchan delivered acclaimed performances in films like **Kabhi Khushi Kabhie Gham, Baghban, Aks, Aankhen, Khakee**, and **Veer-Zaara**, winning the **Filmfare Critics Award** for **Aks**. His resurgence peaked with **Black (2005)**, which earned him the **National Film Award** and widespread critical praise.

Between **2005–2007**, he starred in successful films alongside his son Abhishek, including **Bunty Aur Babli, Sarkar**, and **Kabhi Alvida Naa Kehna**. Though some later films underperformed commercially, his performances continued to be appreciated. His English-language debut, **The Last Lear (2007)**, further showcased his acting depth.

From **2008 onward**, Bachchan remained consistently active. Films like **Paa (2009)** won him another **National Film Award**, while **Bhoothnath, Pink (2016), Piku (2015)**, and **Badla (2019)** reinforced his status as a critically respected actor. His role in **Pink** was especially praised for its moral authority and restraint.

In recent years, Bachchan appeared in major projects such as **Brahmāstra (2022)** and **Kalki 2898 AD (2024)**, the latter becoming one of the highest-grossing Indian films ever and marking his **Telugu debut**. Even in his 80s, he continues to deliver impactful performances across industries.

Television & Other Contributions

- Became a household name on television by hosting **Kaun Banega Crorepati (KBC)** from **2000 onward**, significantly reviving his public image.
- Hosted **Bigg Boss Season 3** and starred in the TV series **Yudh (2014)**.
- Renowned for his **baritone voice**, he has narrated and voiced numerous iconic films including **Lagaan**, **Jodhaa Akbar**, **Mahabharat**, **Krrish 3**, and **The Ghazi Attack**.

• Personal Life

- Amitabh Bachchan married actress and politician **Jaya Bhaduri** on **3 June 1973**. They have two children: **Shweta Bachchan**, an author and journalist, and **Abhishek Bachchan**, an actor and producer. Abhishek is married to actress **Aishwarya Rai Bachchan**, and they have a daughter, **Aaradhya**.
- Shweta is married to businessman **Nikhil Nanda**, a descendant of the Kapoor film family, and they have two children, **Navya Naveli** and **Agastya Nanda**. The Bachchan family resides in **Mumbai**. Amitabh's younger brother **Ajitabh Bachchan** is a businessman who lives a private life away from media attention.
- Though Amitabh Bachchan has been linked by rumours to actress **Rekha** in the past, both have denied these claims. Born to a Hindu father and Sikh mother, Bachchan has stated that he does not strictly follow any single religion. He is a **teetotaler**, **non-smoker**, and **vegetarian**. In **2023**, he gifted his Juhu bungalow **Prateeksha** to his daughter Shweta.

• Legacy

- Amitabh Bachchan is regarded as **one of the greatest and most influential actors in Indian cinema**. Popularly known as “**Shahenshah of Bollywood**,” “**Big B**,” and “**Star of the Millennium**,” he has inspired generations of actors across Indian film industries. His dominance in the 1970s and 1980s made him one of the most commercially successful actors of all time.
- Internationally recognized, Bachchan was voted the **greatest star of stage or screen** in a BBC poll (1999) and was honored by **Time magazine** and **Lincoln Center, New York**. He became the **first living Asian** to be immortalized at **Madame Tussauds**, with wax statues installed worldwide.
- His influence extends beyond cinema—institutions, roads, schools, and landmarks in India are named after him. He has also been recognized for his advocacy of vegetarianism and cultural impact. Even after five decades, Amitabh Bachchan remains a symbol of **excellence, resilience, and cinematic legacy**.